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GitLab

Staff Technical Program Manager

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Dear GitLab team,

Eight courses, eight course leads, no shared mandate, under pandemic lockdown. Delivered in two months. The COVID-19 mega project at Windesheim is the program I lead with when someone asks about managing complexity: mapped 8 interdependent workstreams, built the dependency graph from scratch, ran weekly cross-lead reviews, rebuilt the assessment model mid-flight, and delivered everything on schedule. It is not an engineering portfolio, but the program management skills are the same: find the dependencies others miss, align the stakeholders who do not want to align, and keep the delivery moving.

The technical fluency is not performed. I run Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD pipelines, Linux infrastructure, PostgreSQL and MySQL databases, and a self-hosted AI stack (Flowise, n8n, Supabase) for daily use. I can participate in a technical architecture discussion, understand what is being proposed, and surface the program dependencies - I do not just take notes. I have been doing DevOps for 10+ years across all the labs and engagements I have run.

I want to be direct about one thing: my programs have been research and innovation programs, not engineering shipping programs. The Staff TPM bar at GitLab requires fluency with release trains, CI/CD delivery commitments, and engineering team dynamics I have not navigated in a commercial product org. That is the honest step up. The Netherlands is explicitly an eligible remote location for this role, which is one reason I am applying.

Kind regards,

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